survived despite having lost much fortunes in foreign banks, what harm could come if they sank a little money in the Swadeshi company?[84]

That the shipping company and the administration ganged up to strangle VOC's venture, argued one 'Kalki', was proof of its importance. The Tuticorin–Colombo route was a lucrative one, and if Rangoon, Penang and Singapore were added to it, it would yield further dividends. To miss out on this would be a great loss. Taking a dig at minor enterprises, he said it was more important to train Indian youths in navigation than waste resources on making Swadeshi snuff and Swadeshi chilli powder. Once Indian youths earned Master Mariner Certificates and Marine Engineering Certificates, the dependence on foreign sailors would end. Calling upon people to contribute on the occasion of the forthcoming Tamil new year (Sowmya), he also suggested utilizing the once-in-twelve-years' Mahamaham festival at Kumbakonam to collect funds.[85] Clutching at straws, 'Unmaiyarivon' made reference to the company's hope that the coastal trade could be carried out in a profitable manner.[86] A 'Muppathu Kodi Sahodarargalil Oruvan' ('One Among Thirty Crore Brethren') said he was contributing Rs 5 by cutting down on his expenses and urged others to do the same. One Ceylonese Muslim, addressing fellow Muslims, said this was the time to demonstrate the unity of Hindus and Muslims. He added that a meeting of Muslims in Colombo was being planned where funds would be raised for SSNCo and exhorted Muslims in other regions also to do the same.[87]

Discordant Voices

Apart from such unqualified support there were a few discordant voices as well. The silence of the moderate press in south India was deafening. It kept quiet all through the vicious repression of SSNCo. Save for a small note in G.A. Natesan's *Indian Review* (which was only a reproduction from the Calcutta monthly, *Dawn and Dawn Society's Magazine*) I have not been able to locate another moderate voice in support of the company.[88]

In May 1909, even as SSNCo was struggling, the *Modern Review* published a long, perspicacious piece titled 'The Problem of Regaining